If *the United States* wants to maintain its influence in the world, not only must it not abandon the Middle East, but it must deepen its involvement, not necessarily militarily, but diplomatically, economically, and internationally.

Iraq, which until the Second Gulf War was ruled by the Sunni minority, has become a Shiite state, which, as a result of all of its upheavals, is now under Iran's strategic influence. In the new Middle East, I see a shrunken Iraq, without the territories occupied by the Sunnis and without Iraqi Kurdistan. The United States and NATO countries will condition their recognition of Iran's influence on Iraq on the former severing its ties with Hezbollah and agreeing to an independent Kurdish state in the Iraqi-Syrian area.

The independent *Kurdistan* within the borders of northern Iraq and northern Syria will gain the support of the United States and NATO and will serve as a buffer state between Turkey and the Middle East to the south. Already today, Iraqi Kurdistan is independent for all intents and purposes, lacking only a formal declaration of independence. In addition, the Kurds have constituted the most effective ground force in the war against ISIS and have rightly earned the realization of their aspiration for independence.

Syria, which is a multiethnic state ruled by an Alawite minority and reliant on Russian weapons, will shrink in territory and fall under Russian influence. In exchange for recognition of this influence, the United States and NATO countries will present Russia with a series of demands (relating to Ukraine, the Baltic states, etc.), including that Syria abandon its support for Hezbollah.

"Sunnistan" will be a new country whose borders will be Kurdistan in the north, Iraq in the east, Jordan in the south, and Syria in the west. This new state will be under Western patronage. Its role will be to provide a solution for the large Sunni population in the Middle East, which to this day has no territorial expression. It will also serve as a buffer between the Iranian-Iraqi bloc to the east and Syria and Hezbollah to the west.[5]

The demilitarized *state of Palestine* will be established on the basis of a peace agreement between Israel and the Palestinians, with American and Arab League assistance, as part of the new regional order. This peace agreement will be achieved through negotiations without preconditions but will be based—as nonbinding elements— on the 2002 Arab League proposal and the proposals of Prime Minister Barak, President Clinton,